

# Choosing and combining techniques

- Depends on the:
  - Focus of the study
  - Participants involved
  - Nature of the technique(s)
  - Resources available
  - Time available

# Summary

- Data gathering sessions should have clear goals.
- An informed consent may be needed.
- Five key issues of data gathering are: goals, choosing participants, triangulation, participant relationship, pilot.
- Data may be recorded using handwritten notes, audio or video recording, a camera, or any combination of these.
- Interviews may be structured, semi-structured or unstructured
- Focus groups are group interviews
- Questionnaires may be on paper, online or telephone
- Observation may be direct or indirect, in the field or in controlled settings.
- Techniques can be combined depending on the study focus, participants, nature of technique, available resources and time.